HEIST!

a poker inspired ttrpg about robbing casinos

RULE BOOK

Requires:
2-4 Players (*thieves*), 1 GM (*the house*),
1 Deck of Cards, & Poker Chips

A game by J. Marcos Avina | warcos.net

GAME PLAY

The game takes place over 3 Blinds.

Each Blind is a chapter in the narrative and consists of 3 scenes.

Thieves start the game with 10 chips, these represent their "luck". During each scene they will push their luck to achieve their goals by betting chips. The amount of chips bet will determine the significance of their moves.

Success and failure of a given move is determined by a poker hand that thieves will play against the house. Winning the hand wins them double their bet, loosing the hand looses them their entire bet.

Once a thief runs out of chips, they are gone from the narrative. The game ends when all thieves are taken out or when the thieves beat the final scene in the third Blind.

POKER HANDS

Dropping and Raising poker hands by 1 stage exchanges their rank with the poker hand below an above it.

Rank	Poker Hand
11	Five of a Kind
10	Royal Flush
9	Straight Flush
8	Four of a Kind
7	Full House
6	Flush
5	Straight
4	Three of a Kind
3	Two Pair
2	Pair
1	High Card

BETTING CHIPS

Partial success comes at a narrative cost determined by the GM

OTHER RULES

The "flop" is a set of cards the house reveals from their hand by placing on the table face up

Thieves build poker hands from 8 cards. Moves are used to manipulate the cards into better hands

Thieves make bets to "push their luck" the higher the bet, the more narrative effect their moves will have.

Basic moves can be made by anyone, Archetype moves are exclusive to your chosen archetype

Thief hands are compared to House Hands. If a Thief wins, they win TWICE their bet. If they loose, they loose the WHOLE bet.

BLINDS

3 Blinds = 3 Story Acts

The three blinds in this game are equivalent to the three acts in a story.

Scenes → Opportunities for Narrative

Each blind has 3 scenes. Let the scene names inspires the narrative!

Scenes → Mechanical space for thieves to make moves and play hands

Each blind also comes with "per scene rules". These dictate how many moves can be made per scene and how many cards the house will play with.

SCENE TURN ORDER

1. House draws hand and reveals flop
2. Thieves draw 8 cards
3. Thieves place bets
4. House and Thieves make Moves
5. Poker hands revealed, Chips are distributed appropriately

Deck is shuffled and prepared for next scene

1. No Blind The Stakeout

Use these scenes to gather intel!

Per Scene Rules:
House draws 8, flops 4
House Moves: 0
Thief moves: 1 basic

- Scene 1: The Target
- Scene 2: The Recon
- Scene 3: The Threats

2. Little Blind The Heist

Use these scenes to complicate the story!

Per Scene Rules:
House draws 9, flops 3
House Moves: 1
Thief moves: 1 basic & 1 archetype

- Scene 1: Skeletons & Closets
- Scene 2: Rats !
- Scene 3: It's Personal

3. Big Blind The Endgame

Use these scenes to finish the game!

Per Scene Rules:
House draws 10, flops 2
House Moves: 3
Thief moves: 1 basic 2 archetype

- Scene 1: The Treasure
- Scene 2: The Getaway
- Scene 3: The Aftermath

MAKE A CHARACTER

Decide on a:

Name + **Backstory** + **Archetype**

That's it!

You're ready to play!

USING MOVES

Moves can be made only during phase 4 of a scene (i.e. after bets are placed but before hands are revealed)

The House will make moves first.

Once the house makes their moves, the Thieves can use up their moves as they see fit without taking turns.

Once ever move is made and every hand is built, the scene moves onto phase 5.

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CHARACTER ARCHETYPES & MOVES

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ARCHETYPE: THE FACE

Adept at blending in and standing out in social situations.

DISGUISE

TAKE 3 CHIPS FROM ANOTHER THIEF

MANIPULATE

HOUSE ANSWERS ONE YES/NO QUESTION REGARDING THEIR HAND

ARCHETYPE: THE INSIDE MAN

Connected to the adversary in some significant way.

INSIDE RESOURCES

GET %50 MORE CHIPS WHEN YOU WIN A HAND THIS SCENE

CONNECTIONS

REVEAL ONE MORE UNREVEALED CARD FROM THE HOUSE'S HAND

ARCHETYPE: THE GUY IN THE CHAIR

Has access to valuable intelligence through mostly illegal means.

AID

MOVE 2 CHIPS FROM ONE THIEF TO ANOTHER

GATHER INTEL

CHOOSE 1 POKER HAND TO RAISE BY 1 STAGE

ARCHETYPE: THE WRECKER

Exceedingly competent at disturbing the social order.

DISTRACT

CHOOSE ONE POKER HAND TO DROP BY 1 STAGE

SABOTAGE

IF YOU HAD THE LOWEST HAND LAST SCENE. TAKE 3 CHIPS FROM THE HOUSE

BASIC MOVES

Surveil Discard up to 3, draw back to a full hand.

Cooperate Two players each pick 4 cards. They use this new hand to play the scene*

Steal Draw 1 extra card

Escape Take back half your bet rounded down. You do not need to finish the scene.

Flashback Add a card from the discard pile into your hand.

HOUSE MOVES

Preparations! Discard up to 3 unrevealed cards, draw back to a full hand

Raise the stakes! Minimum bet next scene must be at least 4

Policy Change! Discard entire flop, draw new flop

ARCHETYPE: THE SNEAK

Better than all at being invisible and being in places they are not welcome.

HIDE

TAKE 1 CHIP FROM THE HOUSE

SNEAK ATTACK

DISCARD 1 REVEALED CARD FROM THE HOUSE'S HAND